

The School Trip Transport Checklist

Everything the trip leader needs to keep the transport side watertight, from booking to the journey home. Keep a copy in the trip file.

FIRST Vetting any operator: the four checks that matter

- ☐ **Operator licence:** ask for their DVSA O-licence number and confirm it is current. A legitimate operator offers it without hesitation.
- ☐ **Drivers:** confirm drivers hold enhanced DBS checks and that the company will name your driver before the trip.
- ☐ **Seatbelts:** every seat belted, and booster requirements confirmed for under-12s or under-135cm where applicable.
- ☐ **Insurance:** ask for confirmation of passenger liability insurance in writing.

UGO holds all four as standard and provides them in writing with every school quote.

01 Eight weeks before

- ☐ Confirm numbers: pupils, staff, helpers, wheelchair users
- ☐ Get written quotes with vehicle size and belts confirmed
- ☐ Check the venue's coach drop-off and parking rules
- ☐ Book, and get the booking confirmation in writing
- ☐ Start consent forms with departure and return times

02 Four weeks before

- ☐ Reconfirm numbers with the operator if they changed
- ☐ Confirm pickup point, loading plan and staff positions
- ☐ Share the route and stops with your EVC or head
- ☐ Collect any medical and dietary flags for the journey

03 The week of travel

- ☐ Get the driver's name and the on-the-day phone number
- ☐ Reconfirm departure time and build in a buffer
- ☐ Print the passenger list, two copies, one for the vehicle
- ☐ Brief pupils: seatbelts on, aisles clear, bags stowed
- ☐ Check the weather and adjust the timing plan if needed

04 On the day

- ☐ Trip leader phone charged, operator number saved
- ☐ Headcount on every boarding, against the printed list
- ☐ Belt check before wheels turn, every single seat
- ☐ Agree the return meeting point before anyone gets off
- ☐ Final headcount before the journey home